

MOSTAFA KARAM ABD EL-KADER

Junior Penetration Tester | Web Application Security | Red Teaming

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity-focused Computer science student at Alexandria University, specializing in Web Application Penetration Testing and Red Teaming. Led a 5-member red team that uncovered 10 vulnerabilities (2 Critical, 5 High) and achieved full root-level compromise — results documented in a 31-page professional security assessment report. Active on HackerOne and Bugcrowd. AWS Cloud Security certified. All 3 Cisco CCNA modules completed with verified Credly badges.

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Computer Science — Cybersecurity Specialization 09/2023 – 06/2027 | Alexandria, Egypt
Faculty of Computer and Data Science, Alexandria University
Relevant Coursework: Network Security, Cryptography, Data Integrity & Authentication, Computer Security, Malware Analysis, Operating Systems, Data Structures & Algorithms

EXPERIENCE

Digital Egypt Pioneers Initiative (DEPI) — Government Program 11/2025 – 07/2026 | Remote
Vulnerability Analyst & Penetration Tester (Project Lead)

- Directed a 5-member red team through a full black-box security assessment of an internal non-production web application simulating real-world engagement conditions for the DEPI program
- Uncovered 10 vulnerabilities across 4 severity levels
- Authored a 31-page Security Assessment Report with CVSS ratings, proof-of-concept screenshots, non-technical explanations, and prioritized remediation roadmap
- Applied OWASP Top 10 methodology; used Nmap vuln scripts to flag 3 CSRF-vulnerable endpoints and identify JQuery CVE-2020-11022/11023 (XSS) in outdated library v3.3.1

Maim Digital Solutions (FCDS Collaboration) 07/2025 – 09/2025 | Remote
Web Development Intern

- Architected EventX Studio — a MERN stack event platform with JWT/RBAC/MFA auth, rate limiting, CSRF tokens, CORS policies, and HTTP security headers
- Configured automated test suites using Jest, Supertest, and Cypress achieving high frontend and backend test coverage; reduced bug discovery time significantly

Commercial International Bank (CIB) — Egypt 05/2025 – 09/2025 | Remote
Summer Program Participant

- Gained exposure to how major financial institutions approach cybersecurity, fraud prevention, regulatory compliance, and transaction security in a regulated environment
- Strengthened understanding of digital banking infrastructure relevant to financial sector penetration testing and security assessments

Elevvo Pathways

04/2025 – 08/2025 | Remote

Front-End Development Intern

- Constructed a role-based academic platform front-end with 3 separate dashboards (student, faculty, admin) using Chart.js data visualizations and mobile-first responsive design
- Engineered a custom JavaScript component library ensuring consistent UI/UX across all platform modules; optimized asset delivery for measurable performance gains

Hack Secure

04/2025 – 05/2025 | Remote

Cybersecurity Intern

- Executed independent web application penetration tests against simulated targets; identified and reported 5+ vulnerability classes including SQLi, XSS, IDOR, and authentication bypass
- Conducted assessments with Burp Suite, Nmap, and OWASP ZAP; produced 1 structured pentest report with severity ratings, reproduction steps, and remediation guidance
- Built 3 Python desktop security tools (password analyzer, port scanner, file encryption) using Tkinter GUI, applying secure coding and threading best practices

Mega Store

06/2024 – 11/2024 | Alexandria, Egypt

IT Support & Customer Service Assistant

- Configured and maintained operating systems, hardware, and enterprise software for 20+ end-user devices across a retail environment
- Diagnosed and resolved hardware/software issues with high client satisfaction; compiled structured maintenance reports for asset tracking and audit readiness

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Penetration Testing — Burp Suite, Nmap, Metasploit Framework, Gobuster, Nikto, Dirb, Sqlmap, Hydra, Hashcat, John the Ripper, Netcat, WhatWeb, LinPEAS, OWASP ZAP, Wireshark

Vulnerability Classes — IDOR, XSS, SQLi, CSRF, RCE, Unrestricted File Upload, Privilege Escalation (LD_PRELOAD), Broken Access Control, Authentication Bypass, Information Disclosure

Security Practices — OWASP Top 10, CVE Analysis, Red Teaming, Thread Modeling, Secure Coding, Bug Bounty Hunting, Responsible Disclosure, Strategic Vulnerability Reporting

Cloud & Networking — AWS (EC2, S3, IAM, VPC, RDS, GuardDuty, CloudTrail), CCNA — Routing & Switching, VLANs, ACLs, Subnetting, Firewall Concepts

Programming — Python (security tooling, scripting), Bash, JavaScript, PHP, Java (OOP), HTML/CSS

Web Technologies — React.js, Node.js, Express.js, MongoDB, REST APIs, JWT, MERN Stack

Platforms & DevOps — Kali Linux, Ubuntu, Windows Server, Git/GitHub, Docker, VMware, VirtualBox

SOFT SKILLS

Core Competencies

- Team Leadership & Project Management
- Critical Thinking & Problem Solving
- Technical Documentation & Reporting
- Self-Learning & Continuous Growth
- Attention to Detail
- Accountability & Ownership
- Adaptability Under Pressure

LANGUAGES

Arabic — Native/Bilingual

English — Conversational

PROJECTS

TryHackMe Road — Full Web Application Penetration Test

01/2026 – 06/2026

Shield Secure Consulting | Project Lead

- Scope: Black-box pentest of a Linux Ubuntu web server (Sky Couriers); 5-member team; medium-difficulty TryHackMe production-like environment
- Recon: Nmap service/version scan revealed 2 open ports (22, 80); Gobuster uncovered /v2/admin/ directory; WhatWeb fingerprinted nginx 1.18.0 and JQuery 3.3.1
- Exploitation: Exploited IDOR via Burp Suite to take over admin account; uploaded PHP reverse shell bypassing MIME validation to achieve RCE; caught reverse shell via Netcat listener
- Post-Exploitation: Enumerated server as www-data; found unauthenticated MongoDB on port 27017 using Metasploit auxiliary module; dumped plaintext credentials from backup database
- Results: 10 vulnerabilities (2 Critical, 5 High); full root access achieved; 31-page report with CVSS ratings, POC screenshots, and remediation roadmap
- Tools: Nmap, Gobuster, WhatWeb, Burp Suite, Metasploit, Netcat, Python3, GCC, MongoDB Client, LinPEAS, Nikto

Interactive Bug Bounty Checklist Tool

01/2026 – 06/2026

Personal Security Research

- Coverage: OWASP Top 10, IDOR, Broken Access Control, Authentication, XSS, SQLi, CSRF, SSRF, File Upload, API Security, Business Logic, and more
- Features: Persistent checkbox state, per-category progress bars, severity labels, and one-click export — used actively during HackerOne and Bugcrowd sessions
- Stack: HTML, CSS, Vanilla JavaScript (zero dependencies, fully client-side)

EventX Studio — Secure MERN Stack Event Platform

08/2025 – 01/2026

Maim Digital Solutions | Intern Capstone Project

- Security: JWT authentication, RBAC, MFA (2FA), session/device tracking, account lockout, rate limiting, CSRF tokens, CORS policies, and HTTP security headers
- Features: Full event CRUD, media uploads via Cloudinary, QR-based ticket validation, ticketing system with capacity management, and Stripe payment integration
- Analytics: Real-time dashboards tracking revenue, ticket sales, attendance, and engagement using Recharts with dynamic filtering
- Testing: Jest unit tests, Supertest API integration tests, and Cypress E2E tests achieving high coverage across frontend and backend
- Stack: React.js, Node.js, Express.js, MongoDB, JWT, Docker, Recharts, Jest, Supertest, Cypress

Cybersecurity Desktop Toolkit — Python Security Tools Suite

02/2025 – 05/2025

Hack Secure Internship Project

- Password Analyzer: Real-time password strength checker evaluating entropy, dictionary patterns, and credential complexity with color-coded Tkinter feedback
- Port Scanner: Multi-threaded TCP scanner using Python sockets — scans 1,000 ports in under 10 seconds; exports results to text with service identification
- File Encryption Tool: AES-based encryption/decryption utility using Python Cryptography library; secure key management, progress tracking, drag-and-drop file support
- Stack: Python, Tkinter, Socket, Cryptography library, Threading

E-Commerce System — Full-Featured Java Application

02/2024 – 08/2024

Personal Project

- Architecture: OOP design with extensible product hierarchy (Books, Electronics, Clothing) using polymorphism, inheritance, and factory patterns
- Features: Product catalog with search/filter, user authentication, shopping cart with persistent sessions, order management, and checkout flow
- UI: Java Swing GUI with event-driven design and responsive layout principles; clean MVC separation
- Stack: Java, Java Swing, OOP Design Patterns

COURSES & TRAINING

Red Teaming, Ethical Hacking & Penetration Testing

09/2025 – Present | Remote

Udemy

- Full penetration testing lifecycle: reconnaissance, scanning, exploitation, post-exploitation, privilege escalation, and professional reporting
- Hands-on labs: OWASP Top 10, XSS, SQLi, CSRF, file upload, attacks, authentication bypass, and Metasploit Framework usage
- Real-world bug bounty methodology, responsible disclosure workflows, and writing industry-standard vulnerability reports

AWS Academy Graduate — Cloud Security Foundations

05/2026 | Remote

Amazon Web Services (AWS Academy)

- AWS security architecture: IAM policies, S3 bucket encryption, VPC security groups, NACLs, GuardDuty threat detection, and CloudTrail audit logging
- Hands-on labs: securing EC2 instances, least-privilege IAM access, encryption at rest/in-transit, and responding to GuardDuty security findings

Cisco CCNA — All 3 Modules Completed

10/2025 – 04/2026 | Alexandria, Egypt

New Horizon + Cisco Networking Academy

- Module 1 — Intro to Networks: OSI/TCP-IP models, Ethernet, IPv4/IPv6 subnetting, and Cisco IOS router/switch configuration
- Module 2 — Switching, Routing & Wireless: VLANs, inter-VLAN routing, STP, EtherChannel, DHCPv4/v6, NAT, and wireless LAN fundamentals
- Module 3 — Enterprise Networking, Security & Automation: OSPF, ACLs, VPN basics, network security, QoS, and network automation concepts

AWS Academy Graduate — Cloud Foundations

05/2025 | Remote

Amazon Web Services (AWS Academy)

- Core AWS services (EC2, S3, IAM, VPC, RDS), cloud computing models (IaaS/PaaS/SaaS), the Well-Architected Framework, and shared responsibility model
- Foundational cloud security controls and identity management — directly applicable to cloud-based penetration testing engagements